

Bookmark-X

Extended bookmarks for GNU Emacs 30+

The Bookmark-X contributors

This manual documents Bookmark-X, a fork of Drew Adams' Bookmark-X package, updated for GNU Emacs 30 and later.

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1 Preface

Bookmark-X is a fork of Drew Adams' *Bookmark-X* package, modernized for GNU Emacs 30 and later. *Bookmark-X* supports the entire span of GNU Emacs from version 20 through 26 — a quarter-century of Emacs history. To run on each release the source carried many conditional execution paths, many fallback implementations of functions that became built-in years later, runtime probes for keymaps and faces that were not always present, and duplicated `defcustom` forms with different `:type` widgets for each Emacs generation. This fork simplifies it. It requires GNU Emacs 30 or later and uses many of the modern built-ins that replaced coded functionality in *Bookmark-X*.

Upstream *Bookmark-X* shipped with two notable third-party integrations that no longer match how most users work in Emacs 30: a deep tie-in to Drew Adams' *Icicles* completion framework, and an active integration with `emacs-w3m` (a popular external web browser in the mid-2000s). This fork drops both. In place of *Icicles*, *Bookmark-X* uses plain `completing-read` everywhere and assumes the user brings their own modern completion stack on top — `vertico` and `consult` with `marginalia` and `orderless`, or `helm`, or `ivy`, all work without any package-specific glue (and `consult-bookmark` adds live preview for free; see Chapter 13 [Live Preview], page 26). In place of `emacs-w3m`, *Bookmark-X* uses the built-in `eww` browser: legacy W3M bookmarks saved by older sessions are still recognised by `bm-kx-w3m-jump`, but their handler routes them through `bm-kx-jump-eww` so they keep working, and no new W3M bookmarks are created. This fork also adds an optional Casual Transient menu. See Chapter 21 [Migration], page 37, for the complete change list.

The goal of this fork is to retain the original functionality of *Bookmark-X*. The only major exception is that it does not replace the `bookmark` package by replacing its functionality. Instead, it provides functions that are equivalent to it. For example, `bm-kx-list` and `bm-kx-jump` instead of redefining `bookmark-list` and `bookmark-jump`. This way, both packages can coexist. In fact, built-in *Bookmark* can read bookmark files created by *Bookmark-X* and vice-versa.

2 Introduction

Bookmark-X is a substantial extension of GNU Emacs’s built-in `bookmark.el`. It keeps every concept from built-in bookmarks—named, persistent placeholders into files, buffers, Info nodes, and so on—but makes bookmarks useful as persistent records, not just saved positions.

Bookmark-X enlarges built-in bookmarks in three directions:

1. **Richer bookmarks.** Bookmarks can carry tags, annotations, region information, visit counts, last-access timestamps, and arbitrary user data. They can be highlighted in the buffer they point to, and they remember where they were even when the file has been edited.
2. **More kinds of bookmarks.** In addition to bookmarks that “go” to a location, Bookmark-X ships over 70 bookmark types: Dired buffers, Info nodes, Gnus articles, EWW pages, `man` pages, image files, URLs, desktops, keyboard macros, sets of variables, snippets of text, sequences of other bookmarks, whole bookmark files, and more.
3. **More to do with bookmarks.** The `*Bmxx List*` buffer is significantly enhanced. You can mark, sort, filter, omit, search, query-replace, tag, retag, edit, clone, highlight, describe, and copy/move bookmarks across multiple bookmark files. You can save bookmark-list views, define your own jump commands and sort orders, and cycle through arbitrary sets of bookmarks (“the navigation list”).

Bookmark-X is an additive sibling of the built-in `bookmark.el`. Loading this package does *not* redefine any function from `bookmark.el`. Every command in Bookmark-X lives under the `bmxx-` prefix and is available from its own keymaps (`C-x x`, `C-x j`, `C-x 4 j`). The standard `C-x r m`, `C-x r b` and `C-x r l` bindings still call the built-in. Both systems read and write the same on-disk bookmark file format, so you can use either at any time.

If you would like the standard keys to invoke Bookmark-X instead, see Section 4.2 [Standard Keys], page 6.

3 Tutorial

This chapter walks through a typical first session. Open a few files you actually use, then follow along.

3.1 Creating Your First Bookmark

Place point somewhere in a file you visit often—say, midway through a long README. Type:

```
M-x bm-kx-bookmark-set-confirm-overwrite RET
```

(The shorter key sequence is *C-x x m*.) Emacs prompts for a bookmark name; type *readme top RET*. The bookmark is set at point, and the bookmark file is updated on disk (if *bookmark-save-flag* is *t*, which is the default).

3.2 Opening the Bookmark List

Type *C-x x e* (or *M-x bm-kx-list*). Buffer **Bm-kx List** appears. You see one row per bookmark, in a marked, sortable display.

Try the basics:

<i>n</i>	Next line.
<i>p</i>	Previous line.
RET	Open the bookmark on the current line in the same window.
<i>o</i>	Open it in another window.
TAB	
<i>C-o</i>	<i>Preview</i> it in another window without leaving <i>*Bm-kx List*</i> .
<i>q</i>	Quit. The buffer is hidden; your bookmarks stay in memory.

3.3 Adding a Tag

In **Bm-kx List**, place point on the bookmark you just created. Type *T +* (*bm-kx-add-tags*). At the ‘Tag(s):’ prompt type *doc RET RET* (the empty entry ends the list). A small ‘t’ now appears on that bookmark’s line, indicating it is tagged.

To list only tagged bookmarks: *T S*. To show all again: *..*

3.4 Jumping

You can jump from anywhere in Emacs:

```
C-x j j RET readme top RET
```

bm-kx-jump prompts you with completion; type the bookmark name or use your usual completion machinery to pick. If the *consult* package is loaded, you get live preview as you move through candidates.

To jump in the other window, use *C-x 4 j j*. To jump only among bookmarks of a specific type (Dired, Info, EWW, ...), use *C-x j :* and choose the type.

3.5 Filtering and Sorting

Open ***Bmkx List*** (*C-x x e*) and try:

<i>s s</i>	Cycle through sort orders. Repeat until something useful.
<i>s n</i>	Sort by bookmark name.
<i>s d</i>	Sort by last bookmark access (most recent first).
<i>< / ></i>	Show only unmarked / marked bookmarks.
<i>P B</i>	Incremental filter on bookmark name. Type a regexp; press RET to commit.
<i>.</i>	Show all bookmarks again.
<i>M-t</i>	Toggle the location column (file or buffer name).

3.6 Multiple Bookmarks at Once

Mark several bookmarks with *m* (or *M-m* to mark all). Then:

<i>T > +</i>	Add tags to all marked bookmarks at once.
<i>D</i>	Delete all marked bookmarks (after confirmation).
<i>M-d ></i>	Open Dired on every local file among the marked bookmarks.
<i>Y > +</i>	Copy the marked bookmarks into another bookmark file.

3.7 Live Preview Mode

Type *M-p* in ***Bmkx List***. The mode-line lighter changes to ‘*Pv*’. Now moving point onto a row immediately opens that bookmark’s destination in another window—without selecting it. Press *M-p* again to turn the mode off; the window configuration is restored to what it was when you entered the mode.

3.8 Saving and Switching Bookmark Files

Your bookmarks live in `bookmark-default-file` (`~/emacs.d/bookmarks` by default), and are saved automatically. To save explicitly: *S* in ***Bmkx List***. To switch to a different bookmark file: *L* (`bmkx-switch-bookmark-file-create`).

That is the core workflow. The rest of this manual reads as a reference: each chapter covers one feature in detail.

4 Concepts: list, file, display

Three different things are commonly confused. Understanding them is the single most important thing for using Bookmark-X effectively.

The bookmark list

The in-memory set of bookmarks. It is the value of internal variable `bookmark-alist`. Adding, renaming, deleting, or jumping to a bookmark updates this list.

The bookmark file

An on-disk persistent record of a set of bookmarks. Its default location is `bookmark-default-file`. Multiple bookmark files may exist; only one is *current* at a time.

The bookmark-list display

Buffer `*Bmkx List*`. It is a snapshot view of the bookmark list, rendered with markings, sort order, filters, and so on.

These three can be out of sync. The *list* rules during an Emacs session. The *file* rules across sessions (it is all that survives when Emacs exits). In the display, `bmkx-bmenu-refresh-menu-list` (`g`) refreshes from the list; with a prefix argument (`C-u g`) it reloads from the file.

4.1 Prefix Keys

Bookmark-X allocates dedicated prefix keys for bookmarking, separate from the shared `C-x` register prefix.

Keymap	Default key	Purpose
<code>bookmark-map</code>	<code>C-x x</code>	General bookmark commands.
<code>bmkx-set-map</code>	<code>C-x x c</code>	Create (set) new bookmarks.
<code>bmkx-tags-map</code>	<code>C-x x t</code>	Tag commands.
<code>bmkx-annotate-map</code>	<code>C-x x a</code>	Annotation commands.
<code>bmkx-jump-map</code>	<code>C-x j</code>	Jump (visit) bookmarks (same window).
<code>bmkx-jump-other-window-map</code>	<code>C-x 4 j</code>	Jump (other window).
built-in other-frame jump	<code>C-x 5 j</code>	Jump (other frame).

These prefixes are themselves customizable through three list-valued options:

```
bmkx-bookmark-map-prefix-keys
  Default (list (kbd "C-x x")).
```

```
bmkx-jump-map-prefix-keys
  Default (list (kbd "C-x j")).
```

```
bmkx-jump-other-window-map-prefix-keys
  Default (list (kbd "C-x 4 j")).
```

Because they are lists, you can bind a keymap under several prefixes at once. The setter function rebinds the keys automatically when you customize.

4.2 Binding Bookmark-X to the Standard Keys

Loading Bookmark-X does not redefine any built-in command. If you want `C-x r m`, `C-x r b`, `C-x r l` to run the Bookmark-X versions, add this to your init file:

```
(define-key bookmark-map "m" #'bmxx-bookmark-set-confirm-overwrite)
(define-key bookmark-map "b" #'bmxx-jump)
(define-key bookmark-map "l" #'bmxx-list)
```

If you also want programmatic callers (`consult-bookmark`, `helm-bookmark`, Org-mode bookmark links, etc.) to pick up Bookmark-X's enhancements when they invoke `bookmark-jump`, add:

```
(advice-add 'bookmark-jump :override #'bmxx-jump)
```

No helper command is required. These are plain Emacs primitives; remove the lines (or call `advice-remove`) to reverse them.

5 Setting Bookmarks

`bmxx-bookmark-set-confirm-overwrite` (`C-x x m`, `C-x x c m`) is the enhanced replacement for `bookmark-set`:

- Completion candidates default to bookmarks in the current buffer (or all bookmarks if there are none), so you can easily update a nearby bookmark. A numeric prefix argument expands completion to all bookmarks.
- Overwriting prompts for confirmation.
- Existing tags and annotations are preserved when you re-set a bookmark (see `bmxx-properties-to-keep`).

5.1 Type-Specific Creation Commands

The `bmxx-set-map` (default prefix `C-x x c`) groups commands that create specific kinds of bookmark:

Command	Key	Creates
<code>bmxx-bookmark-set-confirm-overwrite</code>	<code>C-x x c m</code>	A normal bookmark at point.
<code>bmxx-autofile-set</code>	<code>C-x x c a</code>	An autofile bookmark for a file.
<code>bmxx-file-target-set</code>	<code>C-x x c f</code>	A file bookmark (file name at point).
<code>bmxx-url-target-set</code>	<code>C-x x c u</code>	A URL bookmark.
<code>bmxx-make-function-bookmark</code>	<code>C-x x c F</code>	A function or last-kbd-macro bookmark.
<code>bmxx-set-desktop-bookmark</code>	<code>C-x x c K</code>	A desktop bookmark.
<code>bmxx-set-sequence-bookmark</code>	<code>C-x x c s</code>	A composite bookmark.
<code>bmxx-set-bookmark-file-bookmark</code>	<code>C-x x c y</code>	A bookmark-file bookmark.
<code>bmxx-set-snippet-bookmark</code>	<code>C-x x M-w</code>	A snippet bookmark from the region.
<code>bmxx-wrap-bookmark-with-last-kbd-macro</code>	<code>C-x x c C-k</code>	A sequence: a bookmark + the last kbd macro.
<code>bmxx-toggle-autonamed-bookmark-set/delete</code>	<code>C-x x c RET</code>	Set or delete the autonamed bookmark here.

5.2 Bookmarking Without Visiting

You can bookmark targets without first opening them:

- **A file or URL at point.** `bmxx-file-target-set` (`C-x x c f`) and `bmxx-url-target-set` (`C-x x c u`) read a file or URL with the text at point as the default.
- **Compilation, grep, occur hits.** In `*compilation*`, `*grep*`, `*Occur*`, and `*Multi-Occur*` buffers, `bmxx-compilation-target-set` or `bmxx-occur-target-set` (`C-c C-b`) bookmarks the target of the hit at point. The `C-c C-M-b` variant bookmarks every hit; `bmxx-occur-create-autonamed-bookmarks` (`C-c C-M-B` in Occur) creates an autonamed bookmark per hit.
- **Marked files in Dired** (requires `dired+.el`). `diredp-do-bookmark` (`M-b`) bookmarks each marked file as an autofile.

6 Jumping to Bookmarks

`bmxx-jump` (*C-x j j*) is the generic bookmark jump command; completion offers every bookmark. `bmxx-jump-other-window` (*C-x 4 j j*) is its other-window twin. Inside **Bmxx List**, `RET` or *f* calls `bmxx-list-this-window`, and *o* calls `bmxx-list-other-window`.

6.1 Type-Specific Jump Commands

Each bookmark type has its own jump command that offers only bookmarks of that type as completion candidates. They live on `bmxx-jump-map` (default *C-x j*) and `bmxx-jump-other-window-map` (default *C-x 4 j*). A small sampler:

Type	Same-window	Other-window
File	<i>C-x j f</i>	<i>C-x 4 j f</i>
Local file	<i>C-x j l</i>	<i>C-x 4 j l</i>
Remote file	<i>C-x j n</i>	<i>C-x 4 j n</i>
Autofile	<i>C-x j a</i>	<i>C-x 4 j a</i>
Non-file	<i>C-x j b</i>	<i>C-x 4 j b</i>
Dired	<i>C-x j d</i>	<i>C-x 4 j d</i>
Info	<i>C-x j i</i>	<i>C-x 4 j i</i>
man	<i>C-x j m</i>	<i>C-x 4 j m</i>
WWW	<i>C-x j e</i>	<i>C-x 4 j e</i>
Gnus	<i>C-x j g</i>	<i>C-x 4 j g</i>
Image	<i>C-x j M-i</i>	<i>C-x 4 j M-i</i>
Region	<i>C-x j r</i>	<i>C-x 4 j r</i>
URL	<i>C-x j u</i>	<i>C-x 4 j u</i>
Highlighted	<i>C-x j h</i>	<i>C-x 4 j h</i>
Snippet	<i>C-x j M-w</i>	<i>C-x 4 j M-w</i>

The generic “any type” command is `bmxx-jump-to-type` (*C-x j :*). It first asks for the type, then offers only bookmarks of that type. Useful when you do not want to remember the type-specific keys.

6.2 find-file-Style Jumping

`bmxx-find-file` (*C-x j C-f*) acts like `find-file`, but obeys `bmxx-default-handlers-for-file-types`—so HTML files open in `browse-url`, Word docs in `w32-browser`, and so on. With a prefix argument it also creates an autofile bookmark for the file.

There is a family of `bmxx-find-file-...-tags` commands (under *C-x j t C-f ...*) that filter by tags while reading a file name with `read-file-name`, so you can browse directories.

6.3 Mode-Specific *j*

Several modes bind *j* to the corresponding type-specific jump:

Mode	<i>j</i> jumps to a...
Info	Info bookmark.
Gnus summary	Gnus bookmark.
man / woman	man-page bookmark.
WWW	WWW bookmark.

Buffer-menu	Non-file bookmark.
Dired (<i>C-j</i>)	Dired bookmark whose directory is the current one.

6.4 Tag-Based Jumping

Tag-aware jump commands combine three ideas: which bookmark family (file, autofile, this-dir-file, find-file), how many tags must match (all = *, some = +), and whether matching is literal or against a regexp (%).

Command	Key	Meaning
<code>bmxx-all-tags-jump</code>	<i>C-x j t *</i>	With all given tags.
<code>bmxx-some-tags-jump</code>	<i>C-x j t +</i>	With at least one tag.
<code>bmxx-all-tags-regexp-jump</code>	<i>C-x j t % *</i>	Every tag matches a regexp.
<code>bmxx-some-tags-regexp-jump</code>	<i>C-x j t % +</i>	Some tag matches a regexp.
<code>bmxx-file-all-tags-jump</code>	<i>C-x j t f *</i>	File bookmark with all tags.
<code>bmxx-find-file-all-tags</code>	<i>C-x j t C-f *</i>	<code>read-file-name</code> version.

Each command has an `-other-window` twin under *C-x 4 j t*

7 The `*Bmkx List*` Buffer

Open it with `bmkx-list` (`C-x x e`). This buffer is the heart of the interactive workflow: filtering, marking, sorting, tagging, highlighting, editing—everything happens here.

Major mode: `bmkx-list-mode`, derived from `special-mode`.

7.1 Header and Mark Columns

The header shows the current bookmark file and a *title* describing the current filter (e.g. ‘File and Directory Bookmarks’ or ‘All Bookmarks’). The mode line shows counts: marked (`>`), flagged for deletion (`D`), tagged (`t`), temporary (`X`), annotated (`a`), modified-unsaved (`*`), plus the sort order. When a counter is split, ‘N/M’ means “N up to and including the current line, of M total.”

Per-line flags:

Mark	Meaning
<code>></code>	Marked.
<code>D</code>	Flagged for deletion.
<code>a</code>	Has an annotation.
<code>t</code>	Has at least one tag.
<code>X</code>	Temporary—will not be saved.
<code>*</code>	Modified since the last save of the bookmark file.

7.2 Filename Display Style

Long file paths often get truncated at the right edge of the window, hiding the basename—which is usually the most informative part of the path. The option `bmkx-bmenu-filename-style` controls how the recorded path is reformatted before display. It does not change the bookmark data; only the on-screen rendering.

Value	Example
<code>full</code>	<code>/Users/dmg/.emacs.d/modules/bookmark-x/bookmark-x-1.el</code>
<code>abbreviate</code>	<code>~/.emacs.d/modules/bookmark-x/bookmark-x-1.el</code>
<code>shrink</code>	<code>~/.e/m/b/bookmark-x-1.el</code>
<code>basename</code>	<code>bookmark-x-1.el</code>

The default is `abbreviate`. The `shrink` style collapses each parent directory to its first character (two characters when the directory name starts with a dot, so ‘`.emacs.d`’ becomes ‘`.e`’ and not just ‘`.`’) and always preserves the basename intact.

Only paths that look like absolute filenames are reformatted. Buffer names, location strings, and other non-path locations pass through unchanged.

`M-F` `bmkx-bmenu-cycle-filename-style`—cycle the option through `full` $\Rightarrow$ `abbreviate` $\Rightarrow$ `shrink` $\Rightarrow$ `basename` and re-render the buffer in place.

You can also set the option directly with `bmkx-bmenu-set-filename-style` (which prompts with completion), or through the Customize interface. The Casual menu (see Chapter 14 [Casual Integration], page 27) exposes the same cycle entry as `M-F`, with a label that displays the current value.

7.3 Tags Column

By default, the bookmark list shows a single ‘t’ flag for tagged bookmarks but no indication of *which* tags they have. Enable **bmxx-bmenu-show-tags-flag** to add a dedicated tags column between the bookmark name and the file/location column. The ‘t’ flag is preserved.

Option	Effect
bmxx-bmenu-show-tags-flag	Master switch. When non-nil, the tags column is rendered. Default t . Set to nil to restore the historical layout (name column followed immediately by the file/location column).
bmxx-bmenu-tags-column-width	Width of the tags column in characters. Default 18. Joined tag names exceeding this width are truncated with ‘...’; if shorter, padded with spaces.
bmxx-bmenu-name-column-width	Maximum width of the bookmark-name column. nil (default) uses the longest current name. An integer truncates longer names with ‘...’, useful for keeping layout stable when names vary in length.

Tags are joined with a comma and no space, to maximise information density. A bookmark tagged ‘alpha’, ‘beta’, ‘gamma’ in an 18-char column renders as ‘alpha,beta,gamma’; in a 12-char column it renders as ‘alpha,beta,...’.

M-T **bmxx-bmenu-toggle-tags-column**—flip the master switch and redisplay. Reports the new state in the echo area.

To change widths interactively, use **bmxx-bmenu-set-tags-column-width** and **bmxx-bmenu-set-name-column-width** (both prompt for an integer; pass 0 to the name-width command for ‘auto’). The Casual menu’s Tags submenu exposes the toggle and both width commands.

When the tags column is on (or **bmxx-bmenu-name-column-width** is set), **bookmark-bmenu-file-column** is automatically raised in the buffer so file paths do not overlap the new columns. Your custom value, if larger, is preserved.

7.4 Primary Navigation

Key	Command	What it does
n	next-line	Next line.
p	previous-line	Previous line.
RET or f	bmxx-list-this-window	Open in current window.
o	bmxx-list-other-window	Open in other window.
C-o or TAB	bmxx-list-switch-other-window	Preview in other window; cursor stays here.
1	bmxx-list-1-window	Display in only one window.
2	bmxx-list-2-window	Display in two windows.
g	bmxx-bmenu-refresh-menu-list	Refresh (with C-u : reload from file).
q	bmxx-bmenu-quit	Quit.

7.5 Marking and Flagging

The marking scheme follows Direed conventions:

Key	Command	What it does
<i>m</i>	<code>bmkx-list-mark</code>	Mark this bookmark with <code>></code> .
<i>u</i>	<code>bmkx-list-unmark</code>	Unmark this bookmark.
<i>M-m</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-mark-all</code>	Mark all bookmarks.
<i>U</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-unmark-all</code>	Unmark all (or only <code>></code> , or only <i>D</i>).
<i>M-DEL</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-unmark-all</code>	Same as <i>U</i> .
<i>t</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-toggle-marks</code>	Swap marked / unmarked.
<i>% m</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-regexp-mark</code>	Mark by regexp.
<i>d</i> or <i>k</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-flag-for-deletion</code>	Flag for deletion (<i>D</i>).
<i>C-d</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-flag-for-deletion-backwards</code>	Flag and move up.
<i>x</i>	<code>bmkx-list-execute-deletions</code>	Delete all bookmarks flagged <i>D</i> .
<i>D</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-delete-marked</code>	Delete all bookmarks marked <code>></code> (with confirmation).

The pair *d/x* flags then executes; *D* deletes the `>`-marked bookmarks in one step (after confirmation).

7.6 Filtering and Showing

<code>.</code>	Show all bookmarks (clear any filter).
<code>></code>	Toggle “show only marked.”
<code><</code>	Toggle “show only unmarked.”
<i>M-t</i>	Toggle the file/buffer location column.

7.6.1 Filter by Type

Keys ending in *S* show only bookmarks of one type; the matching *M* keys mark them instead. Examples:

<i>F S</i>	file/dir bookmarks	<i>A S</i>	autofile bookmarks
<i>B S</i>	non-file bookmarks	<i>Y S</i>	bookmark-file bookmarks
<i>R S</i>	region bookmarks	<i>Z S</i>	bookmark-list bookmarks
<i>I S</i>	Info bookmarks	<i>K S</i>	desktop bookmarks
<i>G S</i>	Gnus bookmarks	<i>V S</i>	variable-list bookmarks
<i>M S</i>	man-page bookmarks	<i>N S</i>	non-invokable bookmarks
<i>W E S</i>	EWG bookmarks	<i>w S</i>	snippet bookmarks
<i>X S</i>	temporary bookmarks	<i>O S</i>	orphaned local-file bookmarks
<i># S</i>	autonamed bookmarks	<i>M-d M-s</i>	Dired bookmarks
<i>T S</i>	tagged bookmarks	<i>T U</i>	untagged bookmarks
<i>H S</i>	highlighted bookmarks	<i>- S</i>	omitted bookmarks

7.6.2 Incremental Pattern Matching

Type *P PREFIX REGEXP* and the display narrows as you type. Press a non-self-inserting key (e.g. RET) to commit.

<i>P B</i>	Filter by bookmark name.
<i>P F</i>	Filter by file name.

P A Filter by annotation.

P T Filter by tag.

7.7 Omitting (vs. Filtering)

Omitting is a stronger form of hiding: omitted bookmarks are hidden from every view except the dedicated omit view.

- > `bmkx-bmenu-omit/unomit-marked`—move marked to/from the omit list.
- *S* `bmkx-bmenu-show-only-omitted-bookmarks`.
- *U* `bmkx-unomit-all`—can also be invoked outside `*Bmkx List*`.

7.8 Sorting

Repeat *s s* (`bmkx-bmenu-change-sort-order-repeat`) to cycle through every available sort order. Or pick one directly:

Command	Key	Sort by
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-by-bookmark-name</code>	<i>s n</i>	Bookmark name.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-by-last-bookmark-access</code>	<i>s d</i>	Last bookmark access.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-by-last-buffer-or-file-access</code>	<i>s b</i>	Last buffer/file access.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-by-bookmark-type</code>	<i>s k</i>	Bookmark type (kind).
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-by-file-name</code>	<i>s f n</i>	File name.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-by-creation-time</code>	<i>s o</i>	Creation time.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-annotated-before-unannotated</code>	<i>s a</i>	Annotated first.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-flagged-before-unflagged</code>	<i>s D</i>	Flagged <i>D</i> first.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-sort-marked-before-unmarked</code>	<i>s ></i>	Marked > first.
<code>bmkx-reverse-sort-order</code>	<i>s r</i>	Reverse direction.

Sorting is governed by option `bmkx-sort-comparer`; the built-in `bookmark-sort-flag` is ignored.

7.9 Editing

Command	Key	Edits
<code>bmkx-bmenu-edit-bookmark-name-and-location</code>	<i>r</i>	Name and target file (minibuffer).
<code>bmkx-bmenu-edit-bookmark-record</code>	<i>e</i>	Full record (Lisp sexp).
<code>bmkx-bmenu-edit-marked</code>	<i>E</i>	Records of all marked.

<code>bmkx-bmenu-clone-bookmark</code>	<i>M-n</i>	Duplicate; default name ends in '<2>'.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-edit-tags</code>	<i>T e</i>	This bookmark's tags.

7.10 Acting on Marked Bookmarks

- `bmkx-bmenu-delete-marked` (*D*) deletes them.
- `bmkx-bmenu-dired-marked` (*M-d >*) opens Dired on the local files among them.
- `bmkx-bmenu-query-replace-marked-bookmarks-regexp` (*M-q*) query-replaces across their targets, in the current sort order.
- `bmkx-bmenu-search-marked-bookmarks-regexp` (*M-s a M-s*) regexp-searches across their targets.
- Isearch commands (*M-s a C-s* / *M-s a M-C-s*) search marked targets incrementally.
- Tag commands (*T > +/-*) add or remove tags on the marked bookmarks.
- `bmkx-bmenu-list-tags-of-marked` (*T > l*) lists the union of tags of marked bookmarks.
- `bmkx-bmenu-edit-annotations-for-marked` (*a >*) edits annotations of marked bookmarks.
- `bmkx-bmenu-toggle-marked-temporary/savable` (*M-X*) toggles temporary / savable on marked bookmarks.
- Bookmark-file commands (*Y > +/-/0*) copy, move, or create a new bookmark file from marked bookmarks (see Chapter 11 [Multiple Bookmark Files], page 23).

7.11 Describe / Inspect

Command	Key	Shows
<code>bmkx-bmenu-mode-status-help</code>	<i>?, C-h m</i>	Help, status, current file, legend.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-describe-this-bookmark</code>	<i>C-h RET</i>	Detailed description.
with <i>C-u</i>	<i>C-u C-h RET</i>	Internal Lisp form.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-describe-marked</code>	<i>C-h ></i>	Descriptions of all marked.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-describe-this+move-down</code>	<i>C-down</i>	Move + describe.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-describe-this+move-up</code>	<i>C-up</i>	Same, going up.

7.12 Defining Commands From the View

<i>C-c C-c</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-define-command</code> —define a command that restores the current display state (sort/filter/etc.).
<i>C-c C-S-c</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-define-full-snapshot-command</code> —restores the full bookmark list including marks. Larger but complete.
<i>C-c C-j</i>	<code>bmkx-bmenu-define-jump-marked-command</code> —a type-specific jump command whose candidates are the marked bookmarks.

Defined commands are appended to `bmkx-bmenu-commands-file`, which is loaded automatically on first opening `*Bmkx List*`.

7.13 Preview Mode

`M-p` (`bmkx-list-preview-mode`) toggles live preview of the bookmark on point. See Chapter 13 [Live Preview], page 26, for details.

7.14 Casual Menu

`c` (`casual-bmkx-tmenu`) opens a Transient-based menu UI if the `casual-lib` package is installed. See Chapter 14 [Casual Integration], page 27.

7.15 Controlling Where the List Opens

When called interactively, `bmkx-list` hands the buffer to `pop-to-buffer-same-window`: by default the list replaces the buffer in the currently-selected window. No frames or windows are created, deleted, or resized – Emacs’s normal display rules apply.

To override the default placement, add an entry for the buffer name `*Bmkx List*` to `display-buffer-alist`; that variable takes precedence over the package’s default. A few useful recipes:

```
;; Always in the current window (this is the default; included for
;; completeness):
(add-to-list 'display-buffer-alist
  ("\\*Bmkx List\\*" (display-buffer-same-window)))

;; Dedicated side window on the right, 60 columns wide:
(add-to-list 'display-buffer-alist
  ("\\*Bmkx List\\*"
   (display-buffer-in-side-window)
   (side . right) (window-width . 60)))

;; A dedicated frame named "Bookmarks":
(add-to-list 'display-buffer-alist
  ("\\*Bmkx List\\*"
   (display-buffer-pop-up-frame)
   (pop-up-frame-parameters
    (name . "Bookmarks") (width . 100) (height . 40))))

;; Re-use whichever window most recently showed the list, otherwise
;; pop a new window below the current one:
(add-to-list 'display-buffer-alist
  ("\\*Bmkx List\\*"
   (display-buffer-reuse-window display-buffer-below-selected)))■
```

The same recipes apply to the `*Bmkx Preview*` buffer used by live preview mode (see Chapter 13 [Live Preview], page 26).

8 Bookmark Types

A bookmark *type* is really just a *handler*: a function that “jumps to” (acts on) the bookmark. Bookmark-X ships handlers for around 70 of them.

Run `M-x bmxx-types-alist` to list every type registered in your session. `bmxx-jump-to-type` (`C-x j :`) lets you pick a type interactively. Predicates of the form `bmxx-TYPE-bookmark-p` recognize each type.

8.1 Location / File Bookmarks

- **File / local file / remote file.** Jumping visits the file.
- **Directory.** Like a file bookmark, but the destination is a directory.
- **Non-file (buffer).** Like a file bookmark for a buffer that is not visiting a file.
- **Region.** A bookmark with `front-context-string`, `rear-context-string`, plus an `end-position` property. Jumping activates the region (controlled by `bmxx-use-region`). `bmxx-region-jump-narrow-indirect-other-window` (`C-x 4 j R`) narrows the region into a cloned indirect buffer.

8.2 Autofile Bookmarks

An *autofile* is a bookmark whose name is the non-directory part of its file name. `bmxx-autofile-set` (`C-x x c a`) creates one. Combined with tags this gives you a filesystem-wide metadata layer. Related options: `bmxx-autofile-filecache` (advise `file-cache-add-file` to also create autfiles), `bmxx-autofile-access-invoices-bookmark-flag` (make `find-file` also “visit” the autfile, updating its visit count).

8.3 Dired and Dired-Tree Bookmarks

A Dired bookmark records:

- the Dired directory,
- the `ls` switches,
- which files are marked,
- which subdirectories are inserted,
- which subdirectories are hidden.

Jumping reproduces the Dired buffer with the same markings, inserted subdirs, and hidden subdirs. A *Dired-tree bookmark* is a sequence bookmark whose components are Dired bookmarks for a directory and its descendants. `diredp-do-bookmark-dirs-recursive` (from `dired+.el`) creates one for the current Dired buffer.

8.4 Info, man, EWW, Gnus

- **Info.** `bmxx-info-jump` (`C-x j i`, or `j` in Info mode). Mode `bmxx-info-auto-bookmark-mode` automatically creates or updates an Info bookmark every time you visit a node.
- **man / woman.** `bmxx-man-jump` (`C-x j m`).

- **EWW.** `bmxx-eww-jump` (`C-x j e`). EWW can be configured so that visiting a page records a bookmark, via `bmxx-eww-replace-keys-flag` which rebinds the built-in EWW bookmark keys to Bookmark-X's.
- **Gnus.** `bmxx-gnus-jump` bookmarks a Gnus article (group, article, message-id).
- **Legacy W3M.** `bmxx-w3m-jump` still recognises legacy W3M bookmarks saved by earlier versions of Bookmark-X, but opens them in EWW. This fork does not create new W3M bookmarks.

8.5 Image Bookmarks

When you bookmark an image-file target, Emacs's image handler is used automatically. `bmxx-image-jump` (`C-x j M-i`) jumps to one; the description (`C-h RET`) shows the full EXIF metadata (requires `exiftool`).

8.6 URL Bookmarks

`bmxx-url-target-set` (`C-x x c u`) and `bmxx-url-jump` (`C-x j u`). The handler is typically `browse-url`.

8.7 Desktop Bookmarks

`bmxx-set-desktop-bookmark` (`C-x x K`) captures a desktop (from `desktop.el`). Jumping restores the saved desktop.

Options:

- `bmxx-desktop-no-save-vars`—variables to exclude.
- `bmxx-desktop-jump-save-before-flag`—save current desktop before jumping if it was reached by jumping.
- `bmxx-desktop-save-as-last`—add to `kill-emacs-hook` to remember the last jumped-to desktop.

8.8 Sequence (Composite) Bookmarks

A *sequence bookmark* invokes each member bookmark in turn. `bmxx-set-sequence-bookmark` (`C-x x c s`) prompts for a sequence name and the member bookmark names. `bmxx-bmenu-make-sequence-from-marked` turns the marked bookmarks into a sequence in their current order. Members may themselves be sequence bookmarks.

8.9 Function and Keyboard-Macro Bookmarks

`bmxx-make-function-bookmark` (`C-x x c F`) records a function symbol or a lambda expression. With a prefix argument it captures `last-kbd-macro`—a persistent way to replay a keyboard macro. `bmxx-wrap-bookmark-with-last-kbd-macro` (`C-x x c C-k`) builds a sequence bookmark that first invokes another bookmark and then plays the macro.

8.10 Variable-List Bookmarks

`bmxx-set-variable-list-bookmark` records a set of variables and their current values. `bmxx-jump-variable-list` (`C-x j v`) restores them in the bookmark's buffer.

8.11 Snippet Bookmarks

`bmxx-set-snippet-bookmark` (*C-x x M-w*) saves the active region's text under a bookmark name. At any time, in any Emacs session, `bmxx-snippet-to-kill-ring` (*C-x j M-w*) yanks the saved snippet to the kill ring.

8.12 Bookmark-List Bookmarks

A *bookmark-list bookmark* records the state of `*Bmxx List*` (sort order, filter, regexp pattern, title, omit list). Jumping to it restores that state. Defined as either a real bookmark or as a command via *C-c C-c* (`bmxx-bmenu-define-command`).

8.13 Bookmark-File Bookmarks

Created by `bmxx-set-bookmark-file-bookmark` (*C-x x c y*). “Jumping” to one *loads* the referenced bookmark file. With *C-u*, jumping *switches* to it.

8.14 Defining Your Own Types

Define a handler function and set `bookmark-make-record-function` (or pass a handler via your own bookmark setter). To register a new type so `bmxx-jump-to-type` recognizes it, provide a function `bmxx-TYPE-alist-only` and call `(bmxx-define-history-variables)`. The macro `bmxx-define-type-from-handler` (in `bookmark-x-mac.el`) does all of this and also generates a predicate `bmxx-TYPE-bookmark-p` and a “show only” command `bmxx-bmenu-show-only-TYPE-bookmarks`.

9 Tags

A bookmark *tag* is a string (or a string plus a Lisp value) attached to a bookmark. Tags are persistent. Multiple bookmarks can share the same tag; one bookmark can have many. Tags define *sets* of bookmarks (`'blue'`, `'vacation/2024/photos'`, `'todo'`, ...) and most Bookmark-X commands can operate on those sets.

9.1 Adding and Removing Tags

Command	Global key	Bmenu key	Action
<code>bmxx-add-tags</code> / <code>bmxx-bmenu-add-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t + b</code>	<code>T +</code>	Add tags.
<code>bmxx-remove-tags</code> / <code>bmxx-bmenu-remove-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t - b</code>	<code>T -</code>	Remove tags.
<code>bmxx-remove-all-tags</code> / <code>bmxx-bmenu-remove-all-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t 0</code>	<code>T 0</code>	Remove all tags.
<code>bmxx-autofile-add-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t + a</code>	(none)	Tag a file (creates autofile).
<code>bmxx-untag-a-file</code>	<code>C-x x t - a</code>	(none)	Untag a file.
<code>bmxx-copy-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t c</code>	<code>T c</code>	Copy tags to a kill-ring-style slot.
<code>bmxx-paste-add-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t p</code>	<code>T p</code>	Paste (additive).
<code>bmxx-paste-replace-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t q</code>	<code>T q</code>	Paste (replace).
<code>bmxx-rename-tag</code>	<code>C-x x t r</code>	<code>T r</code>	Rename a tag everywhere.
<code>bmxx-edit-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t e</code>	<code>T e</code>	Edit a bookmark's tags.
<code>bmxx-list-all-tags</code>	<code>C-x x t l</code>	<code>T l</code>	List every defined tag.
<code>bmxx-set-tag-value</code>	<code>C-x x t v</code>	<code>T v</code>	Give a tag a value.

The tag prompt uses `completing-read-multiple`: enter tags in a single, comma-separated reply (`'work,urgent,backend'`). Each segment between commas has its own completion against the candidate list. Press RET on an empty input to accept the empty set (many commands treat that as “any tag at all”). Use `C-q C-j` to include a newline in a tag.

Inside `*Bmxx List*`, `T +`, `T -`, `T 0`, `T v` and the Casual tags menu act on the bookmark on the current line – no separate bookmark prompt. Outside the list, the `bmxx-*` variants prompt for the bookmark first.

9.2 Marking by Tag in `*Bmxx List*`

The tag-based mark and unmark commands live under `T m` / `T u`:

Command	Key	Marks/unmarks tagged... bookmarks
<code>bmxx-bmenu-mark-bookmarks-tagged-all</code>	<code>T m *</code>	with all of the given tags.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-mark-bookmarks-tagged-some</code>	<code>T m +</code>	with some of them.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-mark-bookmarks-tagged-not-all</code>	<code>T m ~ *</code>	not with all of them.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-mark-bookmarks-tagged-none</code>	<code>T m ~ +</code>	with none of them.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-mark-bookmarks-tagged-regexp</code>	<code>T m %</code>	with a tag matching a regexp.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-show-only-tagged-bookmarks</code>	<code>T S</code>	show only tagged.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-show-only-untagged-bookmarks</code>	<code>T U</code>	show only untagged.

A prefix argument flips “some” / “not all” and “all” / “none.”

9.3 Tag Values

Use `bmxx-set-tag-value` (`T v` in `*Bmxx List*`) to give a tag any readable Lisp value: number, string, list, etc. A tag with a value is internally `(NAME . VALUE)`. Most Bookmark-X commands ignore values; you can use them from your own Lisp.

A single predefined tag has special behaviour: `bmxx-jump`. If its value is a function, that function is called just after `bookmark-after-jump-hook` runs for the tagged bookmark.

Tag names prefixed with `bmxx-` are reserved.

9.4 Pseudo-Hierarchical Tags

A simple convention—tag names that look like paths (`‘vacation/2024/winter/photos’`)—gives you a tree-shaped organization without any special syntax. Use completion (`TAB`) on partial prefixes to descend the “tree.”

10 Annotations

An annotation is free-text metadata attached to a bookmark.

`bmxx-annotate-bookmark`

`C-x x a a`. Prompts for a bookmark and opens an annotation edit buffer.

`bookmark-show-annotation`

`C-x x a s`. Shows an annotation in read-only mode (`C-x C-q` toggles to edit mode).

`bookmark-show-all-annotations`

`C-x x a S`.

`bmxx-annotate-bookmark-this-file/buffer`

`C-x x a b`.

`bmxx-annotate-all-bookmarks-this-file/buffer`

`C-x x a B`.

In the edit buffer:

- `bookmark-send-edited-annotation` saves (`C-c C-c`; or `C-c C-M-c` when Org mode owns `C-c C-c`).
- `bookmark-kill-annotation` (`C-x C-k`) discards changes.
- The buffer's major mode is controlled by `bmxx-annotation-modes-inherit-from` (default `org-mode`).
- `bookmark-automatically-show-annotations`—if non-nil, jumping to a bookmark pops up its annotation.

10.1 External Annotations (“Annotation Forwards”)

Keep the inline annotation short and “forward” to a file, URL, or another bookmark. Put one of these as the first non-blank line:

```
bmxx-annot-url: "FILE"      ; opens with find-file-other-window
bmxx-annot-url: "URL"      ; opens with browse-url
bmxx-annot-url: "BOOKMARK" ; jumps to the named bookmark
```

When you *show* the annotation, Bookmark-X follows the forward. When you *edit* it (`a e`), you still see the literal text.

10.2 Annotation Commands in *Bmxx List*

Command	Key	Meaning
<code>bmxx-list-show-annotation</code>	<code>a a</code>	Show this line's annotation.
<code>bmxx-edit-annotation</code>	<code>a e</code>	Edit this line's annotation.
<code>bmxx-show-all-annotations</code>	<code>a A</code>	Show all annotations.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-edit-annotations-for-marked</code>	<code>a ></code>	Edit annotations for marked.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-show-this-annotation+move-down</code>	<code>M-down</code>	Move + show.

`bmkx-bmenu-show-this-
annotation+move-up`

M-up

Same, going up.

Annotated bookmarks are flagged with **a** in the display.

11 Multiple Bookmark Files

A bookmark file is a physical file on disk containing complete bookmark records. Bookmark-X makes it easy to:

- Switch to a different bookmark file (replacing the current in-memory set).
- Accumulate bookmarks by loading additional files.
- Save the current bookmarks to a different file with `bookmark-write` (`C-x x w`).
- Create an empty bookmark file with `bmxx-empty-file` (`C-x x 0`).

11.1 Switching

Command	Key	Meaning
<code>bmxx-switch-bookmark-file-create</code>	<code>C-x x L</code> or <code>L</code>	Switch to another bookmark file.
<code>bmxx-load</code> (no prefix)	<code>C-x x l</code> or <code>l</code>	Add bookmarks from a file.
<code>bmxx-load</code> (with prefix)	<code>C-u C-x x l</code>	Equivalent to <code>L</code> (switch).
<code>bmxx-switch-to-bookmark-file-this-file/buffer</code>	<code>C-x x C-l</code>	Switch to a file with only this buffer's bookmarks.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-load-marked-bookmark-file-bookmarks</code>	<code>M-l</code>	Load every marked bookmark-file bookmark.

11.2 Copying / Moving / Creating

Command	Key	Meaning
<code>bmxx-bmenu-copy-marked-to-bookmark-file</code>	<code>Y > +</code>	Copy marked to another bookmark file.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-move-marked-to-bookmark-file</code>	<code>Y > -</code>	Move them.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-create-bookmark-file-from-marked</code>	<code>Y > 0</code>	New file from marked.

11.3 Bookmark-File Bookmarks

Created with `bmxx-set-bookmark-file-bookmark` (`C-x x c y`). “Jumping” to one *loads* that bookmark file; with `C-u` it *switches* to it.

11.4 Default for the Next Session

The default bookmark file for the next Emacs session is the one in use when you quit, controlled by `bmxx-last-as-first-bookmark-file`. Set this to `nil` to always start from `bookmark-default-file`.

Bookmark files are *physical*, not logical, groupings. Copying a bookmark from one to another duplicates it; the two copies are independent thereafter.

12 Highlighting Bookmark Locations

Optional—requires `bookmark-x-lit.el` on your `load-path`. Bookmark-X can draw a persistent *highlight* at the position (or region, or line, or fringe) of a bookmark in its buffer.

12.1 Styles

Style	Effect
<code>region</code>	Highlight the recorded region.
<code>line</code>	Highlight the bookmark's line.
<code>point</code>	Highlight the character at the bookmark position.
<code>line-beginning</code>	Highlight the first character on the line.
<code>lfringe</code>	Bitmap in the left fringe.
<code>line+lfringe</code>	Both.
<code>rfringe</code>	Bitmap in the right fringe.
<code>line+rfringe</code>	Both.

Default style per kind (option):

<code>bmkx-light-style-autonamed</code>	<code>line+lfringe</code>
<code>bmkx-light-style-non-autonamed</code>	<code>line+rfringe</code>
<code>bmkx-light-style-autonamed-region</code>	<code>region</code>
<code>bmkx-light-style-non-autonamed-region</code>	<code>region</code>

12.2 Per-Bookmark Overrides (in `*Bmkx List*`)

Command	Key	Meaning
<code>bmkx-bmenu-set-lighting</code>	<code>H +</code>	Set highlighting for this bookmark.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-set-lighting-for-marked</code>	<code>H > +</code>	For all marked.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-light</code>	<code>H H</code>	Highlight this bookmark.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-light-marked</code>	<code>H > H</code>	All marked.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-unlight</code>	<code>H U</code>	Unhighlight this bookmark.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-unlight-marked</code>	<code>H > U</code>	All marked.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-mark-lighted-bookmarks</code>	<code>H M</code>	Mark highlighted bookmarks.
<code>bmkx-bmenu-show-only-lighted-bookmarks</code>	<code>H S</code>	Show only highlighted.

Each setter command prompts for a style and face, and for a *condition*—an Emacs-Lisp sexp evaluated whenever the bookmark is about to be highlighted. Returning `:no-light` suppresses the highlight. The sexp may refer to free variables `this-bookmark` and `this-bookmark-name`.

12.3 Automatic Highlighting

- `bmkx-auto-light-when-set`—highlight automatically when a bookmark is created.
- `bmkx-auto-light-when-jump`—highlight automatically when you jump.

Both options accept the values: `autonamed-bookmark`, `non-autonamed-bookmark`, `any-bookmark`, `autonamed-in-buffer`, `non-autonamed-in-buffer`, `all-in-buffer`, `nil` (off).

12.4 Pulse Highlight on Jump

If `bmxx-highlight-on-jump-flag` is non-nil (the default), jumping to a bookmark that has no region briefly pulse-highlights the landing line via the built-in `pulse.el`.

13 Live Preview

Live preview shows the bookmark’s destination without committing to a jump. Two surfaces are provided.

13.1 In `*Bmkx List*`: `bmkx-list-preview-mode`

A buffer-local minor mode in `*Bmkx List*`, modeled on the built-in `next-error-follow-minor-mode`. Toggle with `M-p`.

When the mode is enabled:

- Moving point onto a bookmark line opens its destination in another window, without changing the selected window.
- The mode-line lighter is ‘`Pv`’.
- The window configuration is captured on mode-entry and restored on mode-exit.

The display action used to show the destination is governed by `bmkx-list-preview-display-action` (default: `some other window`, `inhibit-same-window`).

13.2 On Demand: `C-o` and `TAB`

In `*Bmkx List*`, `C-o` and `TAB` both invoke `bmkx-list-switch-other-window`: open the bookmark in another window, leaving the cursor in the list buffer. Useful for one-off peeking without entering the full preview mode.

13.3 In the Minibuffer: `consult` Integration

When the `consult` package is loaded and `bmkx-preview-use-consult-flag` is non-nil (the default), the interactive bookmark-name read for `bmkx-jump` (and its `other-window` and `other-frame` variants) is routed through `consult--read` with `consult--bookmark-preview` as the `:state` callback—the same mechanism `consult-bookmark` uses. You get live preview as you move through completion candidates.

If `consult` is not loaded, the read falls back to plain `bmkx-completing-read`—no behavior change.

14 Casual Integration

The optional file `casual-bmkx.el` provides a discoverable Transient-based menu UI for `*Bmkx List*`, in the style of the Casual suite (<https://github.com/kickingvegas/casual>).

14.1 Activation

Requires the `casual-lib` package (from MELPA, part of the Casual suite). When `casual-lib` is installed, `casual-bmkx.el` is loaded automatically and binds:

`c` `casual-bmkx-tmenu`—in `bmkx-list-mode-map`. Opens the Casual menu.

(Casual’s own ecosystem uses `C-o` as the entry-point key, but in `bmkx-list-mode` that is already taken by `bmkx-list-switch-other-window`. `c` was free.)

If `casual-lib` is not installed, Bookmark-X runs unchanged and `c` is unbound.

14.2 Menu Layout

The main menu groups commands by intent: Move, Mark, Delete, Filter and Show, Edit, Files, Preview, Sort (own submenu), Help, Quit. See the in-Emacs help (`?` in the transient) for the live list.

15 Cycling: the Navigation List

Bookmark-X lets you *cycle* through a set of bookmarks—like “favorites” buttons on a TV remote. The set being cycled is the *navigation list* (navlist).

15.1 Defining the Navlist

`bmxx-choose-navlist-of-type`

`C-x x` :—all bookmarks of a given type.

`bmxx-choose-navlist-from-bookmark-list`

`C-x x B`—bookmarks corresponding to a bookmark-list bookmark, or the current `*Bmxx List*` state.

If you do not define one, the first cycling key takes a snapshot of the current bookmarks (or of bookmarks for the current file/buffer, for the file/buffer-specific cycling keys).

15.2 Cycling Commands

Command	Forward key	Backward key
<code>bmxx-next-bookmark-repeat</code>	<code>C-x x f</code> / <code>C-x x C-f</code> / <code>C-x x right</code>	<code>C-x x b</code> / <code>C-x x C-b</code> / <code>C-x x left</code>
<code>bmxx-next-bookmark-this-file/buffer-repeat</code>	<code>C-x x n</code> / <code>C-x x C-n</code> / <code>C-x x down</code>	<code>C-x x p</code> / <code>C-x x C-p</code> / <code>C-x x up</code>
<code>bmxx-next-lighted-this-buffer-repeat</code>	<code>C-x x C-down</code>	<code>C-x x C-up</code>

After `C-x x` you can also rotate the mouse wheel to cycle.

Show `*Bmxx List*` filtered to the navigation list with `bmxx-navlist-bmenu-list` (`C-x x N`).

16 Automatic Bookmarking

16.1 On a Hook

Add `bmxx-set-automatic-bookmark` to any hook to create a bookmark whenever that hook runs:

```
(add-hook 'imenu-after-jump-hook #'bmxx-set-automatic-bookmark)
```

The bookmark created is an autonamed bookmark.

16.2 Idle-Period Bookmarking

`bmxx-automatic-bookmark-mode` is a buffer-local minor mode that sets an autonamed bookmark whenever Emacs has been idle for `bmxx-automatic-bookmark-mode-delay` seconds in the current buffer. `bmxx-global-automatic-bookmark-mode` turns it on everywhere (a bookmark is still only created for the currently selected buffer).

Tuning options:

- `bmxx-automatic-bookmark-mode-lighter`—mode-line lighter (default ‘Auto-Bmk’; set to "" to hide).
- `bmxx-automatic-bookmark-min-distance`—minimum distance (in characters) from the nearest existing automatic bookmark.
- `bmxx-automatic-bookmark-set-function`—which command to use.

16.3 Automatic Info Bookmarking

Enable `bmxx-info-auto-bookmark-mode` and every Info node you visit either creates or updates a bookmark named ‘(MANUAL) NODE’. `bmxx-info-auto-type` chooses between `update-only` (default) and `create-or-replace`; `bmxx-toggle-info-auto-type` flips it.

The result is a persistent log of “what I have read recently in the Emacs / ... manuals.”

17 Autonamed Bookmarks

An *autonamed* bookmark is a regular, persistent bookmark whose name is generated automatically from a buffer name plus position (default format: ‘000058356 foo.el’—nine-digit position then buffer name). It records no region, only a position.

bmxx-toggle-autonamed-bookmark-set/delete

C-x x RET. Toggles the autonamed bookmark at point. Setting one is one keystroke; deleting it is the same keystroke. With a prefix argument it deletes *all* autonamed bookmarks in the current buffer (after confirmation).

bmxx-delete-bookmarks

C-x x delete. Deletes individual bookmarks under cursor or all bookmarks in the buffer (any type).

Other autonamed commands (not bound by default): **bmxx-set-autonamed-bookmark-at-line**, **bmxx-set-autonamed-regexp-buffer**, **bmxx-set-autonamed-regexp-region**, **bmxx-occur-create-autonamed-bookmarks**.

If you do not want autonamed bookmarks to persist across sessions:

```
(add-hook 'kill-buffer-hook 'bmxx-delete-autonamed-this-buffer-no-confirm)■
(add-hook 'kill-emacs-hook 'bmxx-delete-autonamed-no-confirm)
```

Alternative: make autonamed bookmarks *temporary* via **bmxx-autotemp-bookmark-predicates** (the default), and they will not be saved. See Chapter 18 [Temporary Bookmarks], page 31.

Customize the name format with **bmxx-autoname-format** and **bmxx-autoname-bookmark-function**. The special spec ‘%B’ refers to the buffer name within the format.

18 Temporary Bookmarks

A *temporary* bookmark is one that will not be written to the bookmark file. It exists only for the current session.

18.1 Temporary-Bookmarking Mode

`bmxx-temporary-bookmarking-mode` (*M-L* in **Bmxx List**) turns on a minor mode that:

1. Switches to an empty bookmark file.
2. Turns off auto-saving (`bookmark-save-flag`).

Every bookmark you create in this mode is therefore session-local. The mode-line indicator changes to ‘TEMPORARY Bookmarking’.

18.2 Per-Bookmark Temporary Flag

Command	Key	Meaning
<code>bmxx-toggle-temporary-bookmark</code>	<i>C-M-X</i>	Toggle for this line’s bookmark.
<code>bmxx-bmenu-toggle-marked-temporary/savable</code>	<i>M-X</i>	Toggle for the marked bookmarks.
Temporary mark/show commands	<i>X M / X S</i>	Mark / show only temporary.
<code>bmxx-toggle-autotemp-on-set</code>	<i>C-x x x</i>	Toggle: make every new bookmark temporary.

18.3 Autotemp Predicates

`bmxx-autotemp-bookmark-predicates` is a list of predicates— typically type predicates such as `bmxx-autonamed-bookmark-p`— that decide which bookmarks become temporary automatically when created or updated. The default makes autonamed bookmarks temporary.

`bmxx-delete-all-temporary-bookmarks` removes them all from the current list at once.

Temporary bookmarks are flagged with *X* in **Bmxx List**.

19 Bookmark Records

A bookmark is a list whose `car` is its name (a string) and whose `cdr` is a *property alist*. A typical record:

```
("README"
 (id      . "8f3a7b3c-4dd5-...")
 (filename . "/home/me/proj/README")
 (front-context-string . "## Introduction")
 (rear-context-string  . "")
 (position  . 1234)
 (last-modified 26013 12345 0 0)
 (visits       . 7)
 (tags ("doc") ("project" . "myproj")))
```

Every record carries an (`id` . `STRING`) property. The `id` is opaque (`format-time-string` plus random hex bits), assigned at record creation by `bookmark-make-record-default`. Records read from a file that lack an `id` (created by the built-in or by older Bookmark-X versions) get one generated at load time and the alist is marked dirty so the next save writes them.

See Chapter 21 [Migration], page 37, for why the `id` field exists and how it relates to bookmark identity.

19.1 Lookup Helpers

`bmxx-get-bookmark`

(`assoc` `NAME` `bookmark-alist`). Names are unique.

`bmxx-get-by-id`

Find a record by `id`. Useful when a bookmark name may have changed.

19.2 Name Uniqueness

Bookmark names are enforced unique within `bookmark-alist`. Two mechanisms maintain this:

- **Auto-disambiguation on creation.** When `bookmark-store` is asked to create a new bookmark whose name collides with an existing one, the new bookmark is auto-renamed `'foo' ⇒ 'foo<2>' ⇒ 'foo<3>' ⇒ ...`
- **Deduplication on load.** `bmxx-deduplicate-bookmark-names` runs on `bmxx-read-bookmark-file-hook` and renames any duplicate names found in a loaded bookmark file.

19.3 Reading and Writing Bookmark Files

Bookmark files written by this fork are plain printable Lisp. No `print-circle` markers, no shared structure: just the bookmark alist as a single readable form.

The format is identical to what built-in `bookmark.el` writes, with one extra alist entry per record:

```
(id . "20260601T144831-3f5a7c")
```

The built-in ignores this entry on read and preserves it on write.

19.3.1 Caveat: the Built-in Strips Metadata on Re-Set

The interop is safe *as long as the built-in does not modify the record*. When the built-in only loads a file, displays it, and saves it back, every alist entry that built-in `bookmark.el` does not recognise is preserved verbatim — including the `id`, tags, annotation, visit count, last-access time, lighting override, and any other Bookmark-X property.

However, the built-in's `bookmark-set` (and the commands that call it, including `C-x r m`) does not *update* an existing record: it *rebuilds* it from scratch using `bookmark-make-record-default`. Built-in `bookmark-make-record-default` only knows about the standard `bookmark.el` properties. The result: if you have a bookmark named 'notes' carrying Bookmark-X metadata (tags, `annotation`, `id`, etc.) and you re-set it from a vanilla Emacs session via `C-x r m notes RET`, the new record overwrites the old, and all of those properties are gone. When the file is saved next, the metadata is lost on disk too.

To avoid this:

- If you have to edit a Bookmark-X file from a vanilla Emacs session, treat it as read-only — jump to bookmarks, but do not `C-x r m` to update one in place.
- If you regularly use both vanilla Emacs and Bookmark-X on the same machine, keep them on *different* bookmark files. See Chapter 11 [Multiple Bookmark Files], page 23, for how to switch.
- If you accidentally re-set a bookmark from a vanilla session, you can recover from a backup written by Bookmark-X (set `bookmark-version-control` to `t`; backups are kept next to the bookmark file as `'~/ .emacs.bmk.~1~'` etc.).

See Chapter 21 [Migration], page 37, for the rationale behind the `id` field and the file-format simplification.

20 Customization

Run *M-x customize-group RET bookmark-plus RET* for the full customize interface. This section enumerates the most commonly tweaked options. Many more are listed in *customize-group*.

20.1 Bookmark Naming and Properties

bmxx-new-bookmark-default-names

List of functions consulted to generate the default name for a new bookmark.

bmxx-properties-to-keep

Properties preserved when you overwrite a bookmark. Default: (tags annotation).

bmxx-count-multi-mods-as-one-flag

If non-nil (default), count all the modifications a single command makes as one for *bookmark-save-flag* purposes.

bmxx-save-new-location-flag

If non-nil, update the recorded position to the actual destination after a relocated jump.

20.2 Tags

bmxx-prompt-for-tags-flag

Prompt for tags whenever a bookmark is created or updated.

bmxx-tags-for-completion

Which tags are completion candidates: **current** (the default), a list of specific tags, or a list of bookmark files.

20.3 Annotations

bookmark-automatically-show-annotations

If non-nil, pop up the annotation when jumping. Value **edit** opens in edit mode; anything else non-nil opens read-only.

bmxx-annotation-modes-inherit-from

Major mode for the annotation edit buffer (default **org-mode**).

20.4 Sorting

bmxx-sort-comparer

The active sort order. (The built-in *bookmark-sort-flag* is ignored.)

bmxx-sort-orders-for-cycling-alist

The orders cycled by *s s*.

20.5 *Bmkx List* State

`bmkx-bmenu-state-file`

Where the display state is saved. `nil` disables the feature.

`bmkx-bmenu-commands-file`

Where defined commands are appended (*C-c C-c*, *C-c C-S-c*, *C-c C-j*).

20.6 Bookmark Files

`bmkx-last-as-first-bookmark-file`

Start each Emacs session with the last bookmark file used. Set to `nil` to always start with `bookmark-default-file`.

`bookmark-save-flag`

(Built-in.) When to auto-save the current bookmark file (`nil` = never, `t` = on every change, integer = after that many modifications).

`bookmark-version-control`

(Built-in.) Recommended `t` so Bookmark-X's save-time backups accumulate cleanly.

20.7 Live Preview

`bmkx-preview-use-consult-flag`

Use `consult` for live preview in `bmkx-jump` commands. Default `t`. Takes effect only when `consult` is loaded.

`bmkx-list-preview-display-action`

`display-buffer` action used by `bmkx-list-preview-mode`.

20.8 Highlighting

`bmkx-light-style-autonamed`

`bmkx-light-style-non-autonamed`

`bmkx-light-style-autonamed-region`

`bmkx-light-style-non-autonamed-region`

Per-kind default highlighting style.

`bmkx-light-left-fringe-bitmap`

`bmkx-light-right-fringe-bitmap`

Bitmaps for fringe styles.

`bmkx-light-priorities`

Overlay z-order.

`bmkx-light-threshold`

Maximum number of bookmarks to highlight in a buffer.

`bmkx-auto-light-when-set`

`bmkx-auto-light-when-jump`

Auto-highlighting trigger.

`bmxx-tooltip-content-function`

Function returning the tooltip body for hovered highlighted bookmarks.

`bmxx-highlight-on-jump-flag`

Pulse-highlight the landing line after a jump (uses built-in `pulse.el`).

21 Migration from Upstream Bookmark-X

This is a fork of Drew Adams’ Bookmark-X, modernized for Emacs 30+. If you are coming from the original, here is what changed.

21.1 Sibling, Not Replacement

Upstream Bookmark-X *replaced* many built-in `bookmark.el` functions in place: `bookmark-set`, `bookmark-store`, `bookmark-get-bookmark`, the `bmenu` rendering, and more. The replacements were richer, but they also tightly coupled Bookmark-X to every change in the built-in.

This fork is an **additive sibling**. No built-in function is redefined. Every command lives under the `bmxx-` prefix. Both systems coexist and operate on the same `bookmark-alist` and the same on-disk bookmark file; you can call either at any time.

The architectural change that made this possible is the new `id` field, described next.

21.2 The `id` Field: Identity in This Fork

The single most important difference between this fork and upstream Bookmark-X is how bookmarks are identified internally. Understanding this matters if you write Emacs Lisp that manipulates bookmarks; it matters less for interactive use.

21.2.1 What Upstream Did

The user-visible effect upstream achieved was simple: **two bookmarks could have the exact same display name**. This was useful for the *autofile* pattern — creating bookmarks named after files (e.g. many ‘README.md’ files, one per project), all sharing the same short name.

Internally, upstream got this by attaching a hidden tag to each bookmark’s name string. Even though two name strings displayed as the same text, they carried different hidden tags pointing to different records, so the code could still tell them apart. Emacs calls these hidden tags *text properties* on strings; the specific tag was called `bmxx-full-record`.

The same hidden-tag trick also bought upstream three pieces of internal speed and convenience that did not affect what the user saw, but mattered to the implementation:

1. Going from a name to its record was a single hidden-tag read instead of a search through the bookmark list.
2. Programs holding an old name string still worked after the bookmark was renamed in the list — the hidden tag still pointed at the same record.
3. Each row in `*Bmxx List*` carried its own record in the hidden tag of the displayed name, so the `bmenu` code didn’t need to look up the name to find the record.

The cost was paid in the on-disk file format. Hidden tags on shared strings can only be saved if Emacs is told to preserve shared-structure (`print-circle`); the resulting bookmark file contained markers like ‘`#1=#1#`’. Files written this way could not be safely read and re-written by Emacs’s built-in `bookmark.el`, which does not turn on shared-structure preservation when it writes.

21.2.2 What This Fork Does

Every bookmark record carries an opaque (`id . STRING`) property:

```
("README.md"
 (id . "20260601T144831-3f5a7c")
 (filename . "/home/me/proj/README.md")
 (position . 1234)
 ...)
```

The `id` is generated by `bookmark-make-record-default` at record creation time. It uses `format-time-string` plus a few random hex bits, giving an opaque, sortable, collision-resistant key. Records read from a file that lack an `id` (written by built-in `bookmark.el` or older Bookmark-X) have one generated at load time, and the alist is marked dirty so the next save persists them.

Names are now enforced unique within `bookmark-alist` by auto-disambiguation: if `bm-kx-store` is asked to create a new bookmark whose name collides with an existing one, the new bookmark is renamed `'foo' ⇒ 'foo<2>' ⇒ 'foo<3>' ⇒ ...` before being added. Files written by older versions with duplicate names are deduplicated on load by `bm-kx-deduplicate-bookmark-names`.

21.2.3 What Changed in Practice

Compared with upstream:

Capability	This fork
Display-identical duplicate names	Auto-disambiguated as <code>'foo'</code> , <code>'foo<2>'</code> , ...
Looking up a record from its name	Search through the list (was a constant-time tag read)
Programs holding a name across a rename	Should hold the <code>id</code> instead (see Practical Guidance)
Each <code>*Bmkx List*</code> row as its own record handle	Read the line, then look up the name

The first row is the only user-visible change. An autofile use case (many `'README.md'` in different directories) that previously showed two identical-looking rows now shows `'README.md'` and `'README.md<2>'`. The behavior is the same; the visual is different.

The other three rows are invisible to interactive users. Programmatic callers may need adjustment — see Practical Guidance below.

21.2.4 What This Fork Gained

- **Plain printable file format.** No `print-circle` markers, no shared-structure tricks. Bookmark files are valid input to `read` under any settings. About 300–400 lines of property machinery, file-write gymnastics, and “maybe-unpropertize” helpers were deleted from the source.
- **Interop with the built-in.** A file written by this fork is read by built-in `bookmark.el`; a file written by the built-in is read by this fork (and the `bm-kx-read-bookmark-file-hook` backfills any missing `id` fields at load time). Records the built-in does not modify are written back unchanged. See [Round Trip Caveat], page 32, for the one important caveat when the built-in *modifies* a record.

- **The sibling architecture itself.** Without giving up the hidden-tag trick, this fork could not stop redefining `bookmark-store`, `bookmark-get-bookmark`, and friends. The id field made the sibling design possible.
- **Identity that survives rename.** The id lives in the record, so renaming a bookmark in place preserves the id. Sequence bookmarks and bookmark-list bookmarks can safely reference their components by id rather than by name.

21.2.5 Practical Guidance for Lisp Callers

If you write Emacs Lisp that holds a reference to a bookmark across edits, renames, file reloads, or sessions: **hold the id, not the name**. The name is a display label and may change at any time; the id is stable.

```
;; Save:
(let ((id (bookmark-prop-get "my-bookmark" 'id)))
  ;; ... stash id somewhere ...
)

;; Retrieve later, even if "my-bookmark" was renamed:
(let ((rec (bmxx-get-by-id stored-id)))
  (when rec
    (bmxx-jump (bookmark-name-from-full-record rec))))
```

For ad-hoc interactive use the name is fine; the rename window is small and the consequences of staleness are usually just a ‘No such bookmark’ error.

21.3 No Compatibility Aliases

Where this fork renamed an upstream symbol (for example, the `bmenu` buffer became `*Bmxx List*` and many `bookmark-bmenu-*` defuns became `bmxx-list-*`), no compatibility alias was kept. The user-visible Bookmark-X commands are all `bmxx-*`; the built-in `bookmark-*` names always refer to the built-in.

If you had user code that called `bookmark-bmenu-foo`, point it at the corresponding `bmxx-list-foo` or `bmxx-bmenu-foo`.

21.4 Emacs 30 or Newer Required

Loading the package on Emacs < 30 signals an error at load time. Many polyfills for older Emacs (`cl-puthash` `dispatch`, `find-tag-default` fallbacks, Emacs-21 fringe-style guards, ...) have been deleted.

21.5 Dropped External Dependencies

Replaced with built-in equivalents:

Upstream dep	Replacement
<code>crosshairs.el</code>	Built-in <code>pulse.el</code> .
<code>fit-frame.el</code>	Built-in <code>fit-frame-to-buffer</code> .
<code>narrow-indirect.el</code>	Built-in <code>clone-indirect-buffer-other-window</code> + <code>narrow-to-region</code> .
<code>thingatpt+.el</code>	Inlined as <code>bmxx-symbol-nearest-point</code> and friends.

<code>zones.el</code> helper calls	Inlined as <code>bmxx-read-any-variable</code> , <code>bmxx-readable-marker</code> (the <code>izones</code> bookmark type is still gated on <code>zones.el</code>).
<code>linkd.el</code> (dead since 2007)	Built-in <code>outline-minor-mode</code> .
Active <code>emacs-w3m</code> integration	<code>bmxx-jump-w3m</code> routes to <code>bmxx-jump-eww</code> ; no new W3M bookmarks created.
Icicles completion-framework integration	Plain <code>completing-read</code> ; layer <code>vertico</code> / <code>consult</code> / <code>marginalia</code> on top.
<code>dired+.el</code> is still recognised as an optional dependency.	

21.6 File Format

Bookmark files are now plain printable Lisp—no `print-circle/#1=#1#` markers, no `bmxx-full-record` text property on names. Files round-trip through built-in `bookmark.el` losslessly.

21.7 New Capabilities

- Live preview in `*Bmxx List*` via `bmxx-list-preview-mode` (See Chapter 13 [Live Preview], page 26).
- `consult` integration for `bmxx-jump` (same chapter).
- Optional Casual-style Transient menu via `casual-bmxx.el` (See Chapter 14 [Casual Integration], page 27).
- Stable bookmark identity via the `id` record property.
- Hard Emacs-30 gate, much cleaner source (~600 lines of dead version-gates and polyfills removed).

Appendix A GNU General Public License

Version 3, 29 June 2007

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(Index is nonexistent)

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